Brandon Jahoor

Robotics Software Engineering for Humanoid Embodiment of Physical AI

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University of Waterloo | *Candidate for BASc in Mechatronics Engineering Honours, Minor in Artificial Intelligence* *2028*

Skills

Robotics: Isaac Sim & Lab, URDF/USD, ROS2, controls, IK/FK, Nav2, path planning
ML & Perception: ACT, VLA, RL, LeRobot, Hugging Face, computer vision, OpenCV, RealSense
Software: Python, C++, Docker, Linux/Ubuntu, Claude Code, llama.cpp, Ollama
Hardware & Design: SolidWorks, 3D printing, SO-ARM101, Nvidia Jetson, Raspberry Pi, prototyping

Experience

Robotics Software Engineering (Co-op) Sept 2026 – April 2027
Axibo AI | *Humanoids* | *site* *Ontario*

- Fine-tune SOTA VLAs ($\pi_{0.5}$, **DM0.5**, **GR00T N1.7**) as generalizable bimanual and whole-body policies, both integrated with the **WBC** and locomotion policies.
- Engineer batched synthetic data generation for delta-EE bimanual **cross-embodiment** in **Genesis**, **Isaac** and **MuJoCo**, with augmentation and domain randomization.
- Develop the custom **UMI** data collection pipeline and optimize its training recipes.
- Develop and own training on a custom **openpi** fork (**JAX/Orbax**) and **PyTorch**, maximizing use of public data, with sharded cloud training and recipes tuned to cut compute cost and speed up iteration.
- Deploy bimanual and whole-body policies end-to-end, developing the deployment tooling, workflows and runtime as forks of SOTA systems, integrating **WBC** and **RTC**.
- Design and run **sim-to-sim** and **sim-to-real** evaluation, raising benchmark scores by tuning training recipes and inference settings.
- Develop the team's **agent-centric** pipelines, workflows and tooling across the data, training and evaluation stack.
- Architect humanoid runtimes spanning **LLM/agent-harness** orchestration of VLA skills, VLA-driven whole-body control and manipulation policies, and an upper-body VLA with a lower-body locomotion policy, all coordinated through the **WBC**.

Robotics Software Engineering (Co-op) Jan 2026 – April 2026
Thalassa Robotics | *Subsea Robotics* | *site* · *portfolio* *California*

- Built a high-fidelity toolchain on **Isaac Sim** used team-wide, integrating and configuring **optics and hydrodynamics** it lacks.
- Prepared the robot's **USD** model and joint articulation so the simulated assembly matched the real one.
- Layered control abstractions so simulated motors drive exactly like the real servos, with acceleration-bounded interpolation.

Robotics Software Engineering (Research Assistant) Sept 2025 – Dec 2025
University of Waterloo RoboHub | *Robotics Research Lab* | *gitlab* · *site* · *portfolio* *Ontario*

- Streamed **human arm motion** from **Xsens MOCAP** into **ROS2** in real time, for retargeting onto a 7-axis **Franka Emika Panda**.
- Containerised the **ROS2** stack in **Docker** so results reproduced across the lab's workstations.

Robotics Engineering (Co-op) June 2025 – Aug 2025
University of Waterloo Robotics Team | *Mars Rover Team* | *github* · *site* · *portfolio* *Ontario*

- Developed a **ROS2 RealSense RGB-D** pipeline and solved **Mars rover drivetrain kinematics** on an **Nvidia Jetson**.

Robotics Engineering (Co-op) May 2025 – June 2025
BHF Robotics | *Agricultural Robotics* | *site* · *portfolio* *Ontario*

- Implemented **ROS2 autodrive** and trained a **deep-learning** weed/crop detector for an autonomous farming robot.

Projects

VLA Finetuning | *SmolVLA, LeRobot, SO-ARM101, Nvidia Jetson* | github · portfolio

- Trained **ACT** and **SmolVLA** on 50–100 teleoperated demos/task, running **30 Hz** on a Jetson Orin Nano.
- Optimized batch and worker counts for **LeRobot PyTorch** training on an **RTX 3060 Ti**.

Chess Robot | *SO-ARM101, SolidWorks, 3D printing, LeRobot, Placo, Python* | *Stealth Startup* | portfolio

- **CAD**-modified an **SO-ARM101** and built its rig, then developed a three-call Python API that plugs straight into a chess engine.
- Extended reach and fused the wrist to drop a motor, updating the **URDF** model, solver constraints and **LeRobot** driver.
- Built the motion engine over **LeRobot** and **Placo** IK: convergence loops, **1 mm** waypoints, **PID gravity compensation**.

Autonomous Navigation Stack | *ROS2, C++, LiDAR, A*, Foxglove* | *WATonomous* | github · portfolio
Robot Arm Simulation | *Isaac Sim, Isaac Lab, CUDA, RL* | *Stealth Startup* | portfolio
Hexapod Robot | *Nvidia Jetson, OWL-ViT, SO-ARM101, RealSense* | portfolio
AI Roommate | *Nvidia Jetson, Qwen2.5-0.5B, YOLOv8s, FastAPI* | github · portfolio
Autonomous Rover Simulation | *Gazebo, ROS2, Nav2, Python* | *RoboHub* | github · portfolio
AI Object Detection | *ROS2, OWL-ViT, RealSense, OpenCV, Python* | github · portfolio

See my portfolio: bjahoor.github.io